

Alla Vostra Mobile App Work Log - May 27, 2026

Compiled summary for May 27, 2026 - focus: mobile Expo/Android navigation polish, AppHeader behavior, image-load performance, swipe navigation, and scroll tuning.

Generated automatically on May 27, 2026 at 11:10 PM EDT.

Current Baseline to Preserve

- Work remained inside /Users/prahlin/Desktop/alla_vostra/mob. The desktop / other site was not edited during this session.
- The accepted overlay-header architecture from May 25 remains the mobile baseline: AppHeader is mounted persistently from app/_layout.js above Home, Products, About Us, and Contact.
- The Shop screen remains isolated from the shared white carousel navigation row and background3.png hero behavior.
- Dream Avenue and TT Fors typography, the orange Alla Vostra brand bar, the cream #FFFCF2 surface, and the Android 36-layer radial center shadow remain part of the design baseline.
- The four main navigation screens remain Home, Products, About Us, and Contact, with the route order Home -> Products -> About Us -> Contact -> Home and the reverse order looping back.

Main Goals We Worked Toward

- Replace circular page indicators with thin horizontal progress bars aligned to the bottom of the white top navigation bar.
- Make the active orange indicator slide into position rather than flipping instantly between static segments.
- Improve perceived and actual top-nav route switching speed on Android Expo Go.
- Compress oversized mobile image assets to reduce Android decode/render cost without visibly damaging the design.
- Allow the entire body of each main screen to respond to horizontal swipes, not only the top carousel/header area.
- Remove scroll glitches around the exact point where the orange top banner leaves view and the white nav transitions into the top-nav-only state.
- Preserve the AppHeader collapsed/top-nav-only state when changing between main screens, while preventing background3.png from flashing during those transitions.
- Tune vertical scroll momentum so users do not accidentally fly past important content.

Work Completed - Navigation Indicator System

- Converted the old dot-style nav indicators into four equal-width horizontal bar segments, each representing 25% of the screen width.
- Changed inactive indicators from pure white to the same cream color as the top nav bar (#FFFCF2), so they no longer stand out as separate white shapes.
- Reduced the indicator bar height through visual tuning until the accepted height settled at 6px.
- Added, refined, and ultimately stabilized the thin separator line behavior around the indicator top edge. Android elevation/shadow artifacts were investigated and removed from the indicator stack.
- Replaced per-segment active color switching with a single Animated.View orange segment that translates horizontally to the active page.
- Doubled the slide speed once, settling the indicator animation duration at 130ms.
- Added optimistic indicator movement so the orange indicator begins moving at tap/swipe intent time rather than waiting for Expo Router to complete route resolution.

Work Completed - Android / Expo Go Responsiveness

- Investigated why navigation felt instant in Expo web on desktop but slower in Expo Go on Android.

- Identified likely Android costs: Expo Go development-mode overhead, native route transition work, image decoding of oversized PNG assets, and screen mount/render cost.
- Changed main-screen navigation from `router.push(route)` to `router.replace(route)` for Home, Products, About Us, and Contact to avoid stack buildup. Shop still uses `router.push` to preserve its separate flow.
- Disabled Expo Router stack transition animation via `animation: "none"` in `app/_layout.js`. This was confirmed by the user as a noticeable improvement.
- Kept the optimistic orange indicator movement after it improved perceived responsiveness, even while actual screen content still depends on React Native / Expo Router mounting.

Work Completed - Image Asset Optimization

- Measured the main mobile image assets and found `convenience111.png` was 21MB at 4151x4151, far larger than needed for the mobile layout.
- Compressed `convenience111.png` to 1200x1200, reducing it from 21MB to approximately 2.2MB. This image is used on Home and About Us.
- Compressed the three product board images used by Products and Shop: `janny1brevised.png` from 4.0MB to 1.8MB, `janny2drevised.png` from 2.2MB to 1.6MB, and `janny3erevised.png` from 2.5MB to 1.8MB.
- Preserved backups in `/private/tmp` before compressing:
`/private/tmp/alla_vostra_image_backup_20260527_202941` for `convenience111.png` and
`/private/tmp/alla_vostra_image_backup_20260527_203748` for the janny product images.
- Left `background3.png`, `passion111.png`, and `taste111.png` unchanged because their file sizes were already comparatively reasonable.

Work Completed - Full-Screen Swipe Navigation

- Added `utils/useMainScreenSwipeNavigation.js` as a shared hook for body-level horizontal swipe navigation across Home, Products, About Us, and Contact.
- Attached the shared swipe handlers to the outer screen View of each main page so users can swipe from regular content areas, not only the header/carousel/hero region.
- Tuned the swipe threshold after initial testing felt too strict. Activation now begins at 10px of horizontal movement, navigation commits at 30px, and quick flicks can count with 14px of movement when velocity is clear.
- Allowed mildly diagonal gestures to count as horizontal as long as left/right motion is meaningfully dominant, reducing the awkward need for perfectly horizontal swipes.
- Preserved normal vertical scrolling by keeping a horizontal-distance/vertical-distance guard in the `PanResponder` logic.

Work Completed - AppHeader Scroll / Sticky Behavior

- Removed the earlier threshold-triggered `stickyPadding` timing animation that caused awkward split-second glitches when scrolling gently or very quickly around the 120px header threshold.
- Encountered and fixed the Android native animated module warning that `paddingTop` is unsupported by the native animated module. Animated layout properties were removed from that section.
- Restored the visual `resize/reposition` behavior without animating unsupported layout properties by using `transform/opacity`-based movement instead of animated `paddingTop` or `height`.
- Added a sticky expansion layer under the white nav and tuned `indicator/expansion` layering so the orange active bar remained visible and the separator line did not generate elevation-based Android artifacts.
- Moved the active screen-name text slightly upward by 3.6px in its pre-scroll state so it appears more vertically centered between the top nav edge and the indicator separator.

Work Completed - Header Carryover Between Screens

- Removed the `mount-time scrollY.setValue(0)` reset from Home, Products, About Us, and Contact so the shared AppHeader can preserve its collapsed/top-nav-only state across route changes.

- Added `utils/useHeaderSyncedInitialOffset.js` so newly mounted screens can initialize their `ScrollView` offset to match the carried header state rather than mounting at visual scroll zero.
- Adjusted the carried offset behavior so a screen opened from the top-nav-only state does not reveal `background3.png` just because the new screen loaded fresh.
- Added route-specific `background3.png` suppression: if a screen changes while the header is already collapsed, `background3.png` is forced fully invisible until the user scrolls back to the top/original header state.
- Kept the top nav bar, active screen name, and orange indicator responsive to route changes while preventing the original app header assets from announcing a new screen load.

Work Completed - background3.png Motion and Fade

- The accidental `background3.png` opacity fade became an accepted design feature after testing. It now fades in/out during real vertical scroll instead of disappearing abruptly.
- Removed the fade from the orange top bar itself. *Alla Vostra* and *SHOP* now push in/out with the header instead of fading.
- Dramatically slowed `background3.png` hero scale/vertical movement by increasing the hero animation scroll distance from 500 to 2000.
- Adjusted the `background3.png` fade distance proportionally, settling at a 480px fade range so the slow fade remains matched to the much slower image movement.
- Added route suppression so the slow fade does not let a faint `background3.png` appear when navigating between screens in the collapsed top-nav-only state.

Work Completed - Vertical Scroll Feel

- Added `ScrollView` deceleration tuning to all four main screens to reduce accidental content skipping caused by fast momentum scrolling.
- Initial `decelerationRate="fast"` made content progression more deliberate but felt too heavy.
- Final accepted value became `decelerationRate={0.95}`, giving a moderate amount of extra scroll effort without making vertical scrolling feel clumsy.
- Best-practice terminology for this commit area: scroll deceleration, momentum scrolling, scroll friction, and reducing momentum-based overscroll.

Files Touched / Added

- `mob/components/AppHeader.js` - indicator animation, optimistic routing feedback, header scroll behavior, hero fade/motion, route-specific background suppression, orange bar push behavior.
- `mob/styles/headerStyles.js` - indicator bar dimensions, inactive cream color, separator behavior, layering, elevation removal, sticky expansion layer.
- `mob/app/_layout.js` - stack animation disabled for faster main-screen navigation.
- `mob/app/index.js`, `mob/app/products.js`, `mob/app/aboutus.js`, `mob/app/contact.js` - full-screen swipe handlers, synced initial offsets, scroll deceleration tuning, removed mount-time scroll reset.
- `mob/utils/useMainScreenSwipeNavigation.js` - new shared full-screen swipe navigation hook.
- `mob/utils/useHeaderSyncedInitialOffset.js` - new shared initial `ScrollView` offset helper for preserving header state across route changes.
- `mob/convenience111.png`, `mob/janny1brevised.png`, `mob/janny2drevised.png`, `mob/janny3erevised.png` - compressed mobile image assets.

Expo / Metro / Node / GitHub Notes

- Expo Go on Android was the primary runtime used for performance and interaction testing. Several changes were explicitly driven by Android-only behavior that did not appear on Expo web in the same way.
- Expo Router behavior was refined through `router.replace` for the four main screens and stack animation: "none" in the root layout. These changes were intended to reduce route transition overhead and avoid stack buildup.

- React Native Animated native-module limitations were significant: Android warned that animated `paddingTop` is unsupported, so the final header transition avoids animated layout properties and uses `transform/opacity` instead.
- Node syntax checks were run repeatedly with `node --check` on edited JS files after each meaningful code change.
- Metro/Expo cache or config was not the direct focus today, but Expo Go development-mode behavior and Metro-served React Native runtime performance informed the debugging decisions.
- Git/GitHub work was limited to commit planning rather than pushing from this assistant session. A detailed commit message was prepared: "Improve Android nav responsiveness and optimize mobile image assets" with bullets covering route animation, image compression, optimistic indicator movement, and preserved nav logic.
- Git status/diff commands intermittently hung while scanning large binary image changes, matching prior May 26 notes about repository refresh/index slowness around generated or binary-heavy changes.

Important Constraints Going Forward

- Do not restore `mount-time scrollY.setValue(0)` on the four main screens unless intentionally abandoning header-state carryover.
- Do not animate `paddingTop` or other unsupported layout properties through the native animated module on Android.
- Do not let `background3.png` appear during screen-to-screen navigation when the header is already in the collapsed top-nav-only state.
- Do not reintroduce Android elevation on the indicator strip or separator if it recreates faint duplicate shadow-line artifacts.
- Keep Shop isolated from the shared hero/top-nav behavior unless a later task explicitly changes the shop architecture.
- If visual tuning continues, test on Android Expo Go first because web behavior can hide native Animated and image-decoding issues.

Best Next Approach

- Test the final header carryover and route-specific background suppression on Android using slow scroll, fast fling, horizontal swipe, and direct top-nav taps.
- If `background3.png` still peeks during collapsed route changes, move suppression state into a shared header/navigation context rather than relying solely on `AppHeader-local` route detection.
- If scroll deceleration needs further tuning, adjust `decelerationRate` numerically in small increments around 0.95 instead of returning directly to "fast".
- Before committing, avoid broad git diff commands over binary assets if the index is slow. Prefer targeted status checks or allow Git refresh operations to complete fully.
- Future performance work should consider replacing large PNGs with appropriately sized WebP/JPEG/PNG variants if visual fidelity permits.

Closing Summary

- The May 27 session turned the mobile app header from a mostly static navigation control into a polished, stateful interaction system. The four main screens now support body-level swipe navigation, faster Android route switching, compressed images, reduced momentum scrolling, persistent header state between screens, and carefully controlled `background3.png` visibility.
- The most important outcome is that Android Expo Go now better matches the intended Alla Vostra mobile experience: smoother navigation, fewer accidental content skips, no distracting header glitches at the sticky threshold, and no unwanted `background3.png` flash when moving between screens in the top-nav-only state.